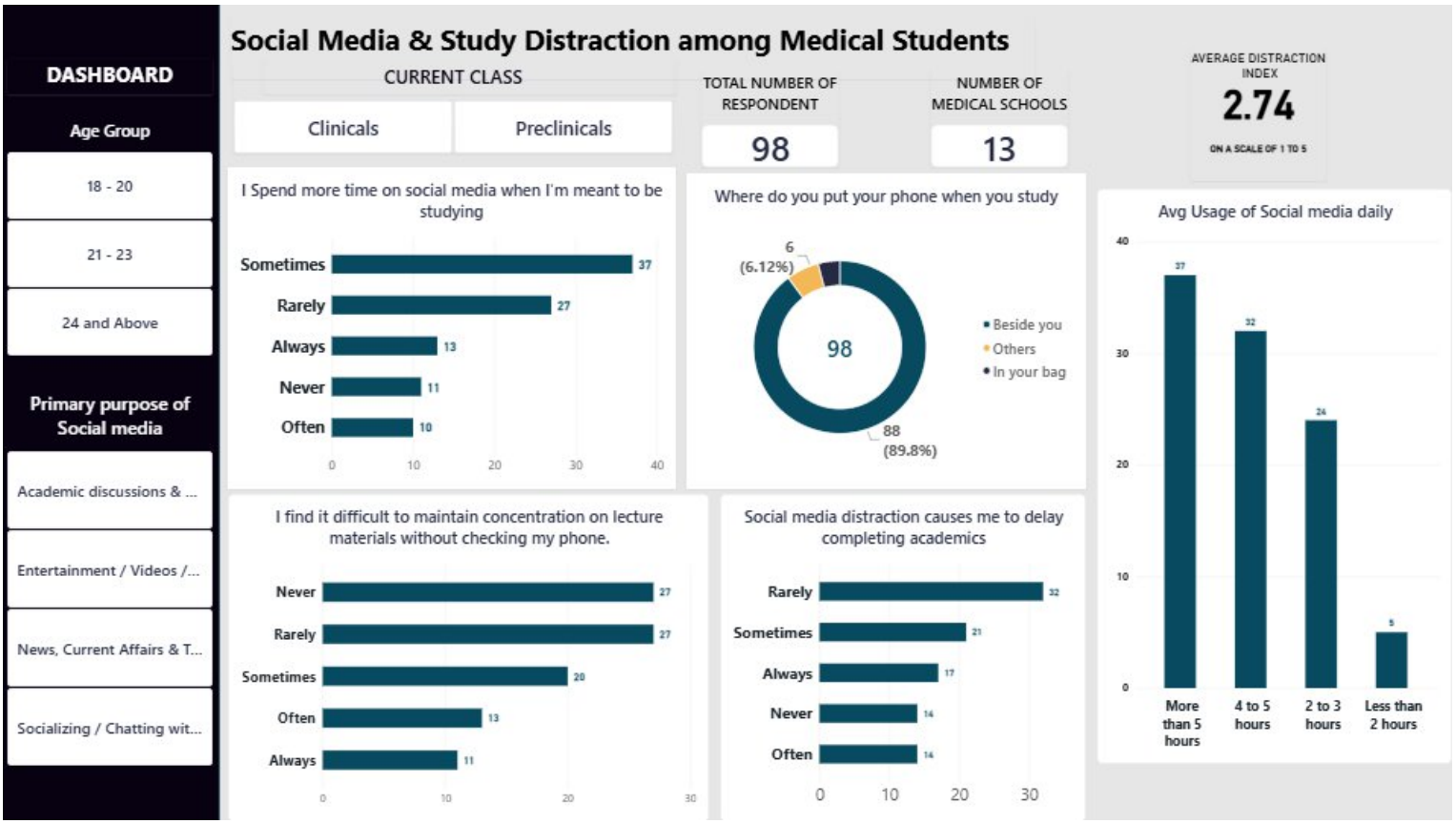
Daily Social Media Use and Study Focus Report

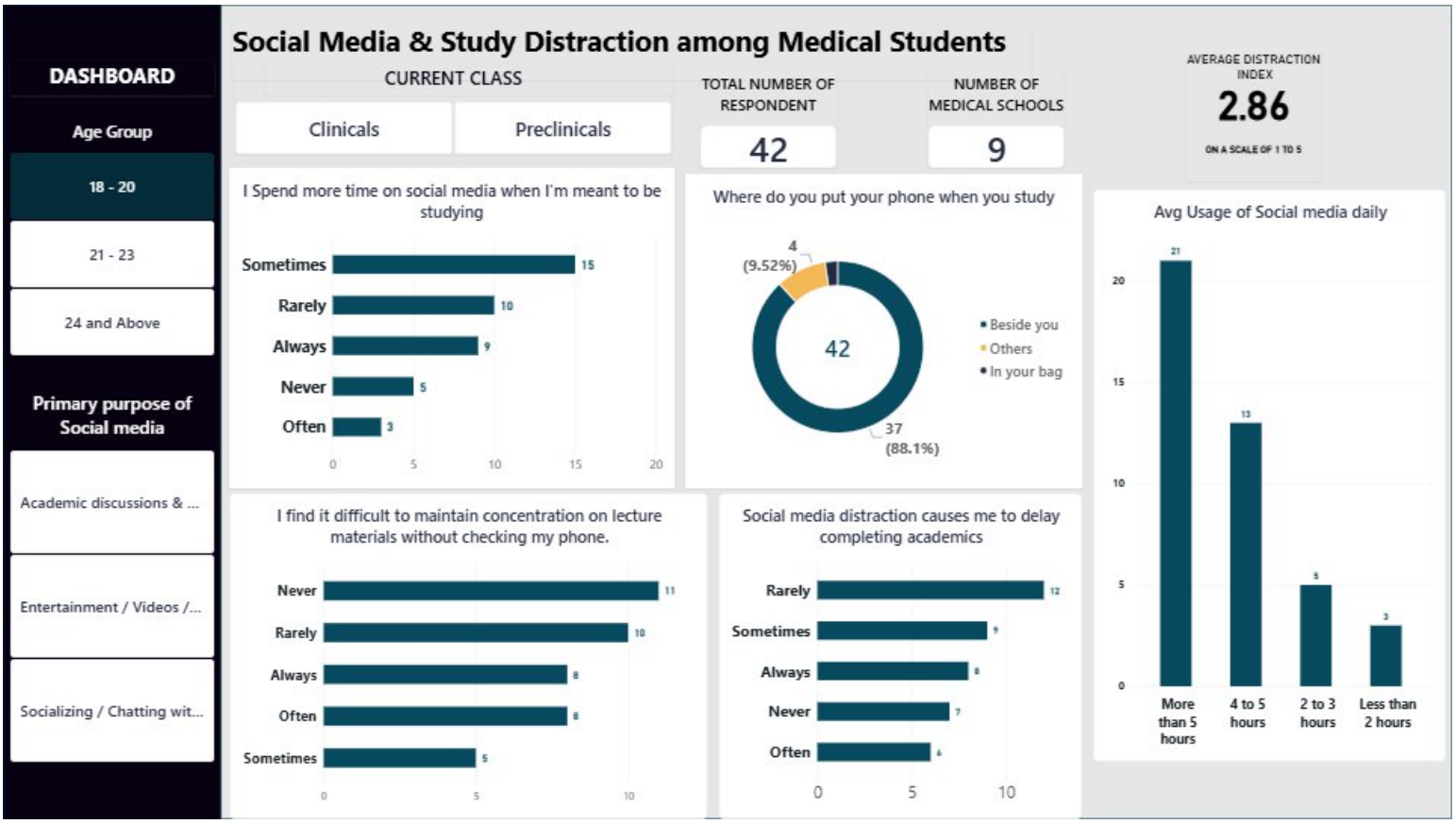


SUMMARY

The dashboard summarizes responses from 98 medical students across 13 institutions. Most respondents come from three schools: Bayelsa Medical University (36%), the University of Ilorin (33%) and Benson Idahosa University (18%). Just over half (54%) are aged 21 to 23, and 43% are aged 18 to 20. Clinical students make up 78% of the sample and pre-clinical students 22%. Entertainment and video content is the most common main reason for using social media (64%), followed by socializing (19%), academic discussion (9%) and news (7%).

Social media use is heavy. More than a third of respondents (38%) spend over five hours a day on social media, and another third (33%) spend four to five hours. In total, 70% use it for at least four hours daily, while only 5% use it for less than two hours. Almost nine in ten students (90%) keep their phone beside them while studying. Only 4% keep it in a bag, and 6% place it elsewhere. Self-reported distraction is moderate overall, with a clear pattern across the three statements shown. On a scale from 1 (Never) to 5 (Always), the average Distraction Index is 2.74, which falls between “Rarely” and “Sometimes”. The most common problem is delaying academic work: 32% say social media often or always causes them to postpone assignments or reading notes. Spending more time scrolling than intended while supposed to be studying is reported often or always by 24%, and “Sometimes” is the single most common answer (38%). Concentration during lectures is the least affected: 55% say they never or rarely struggle to concentrate without checking their phone, while 25% often or always do.

Taken together, the data shows that heavy social media use and constant phone proximity are the norm among these students, but their effect on study is uneven. Most students report occasional rather than constant distraction, while a substantial minority (roughly a quarter to a third, depending on the statement) report frequent problems, especially with delaying assignments and reading. These results are self-reported and from a convenience sample dominated by three schools, so they describe this group and should not be generalized to all medical students.

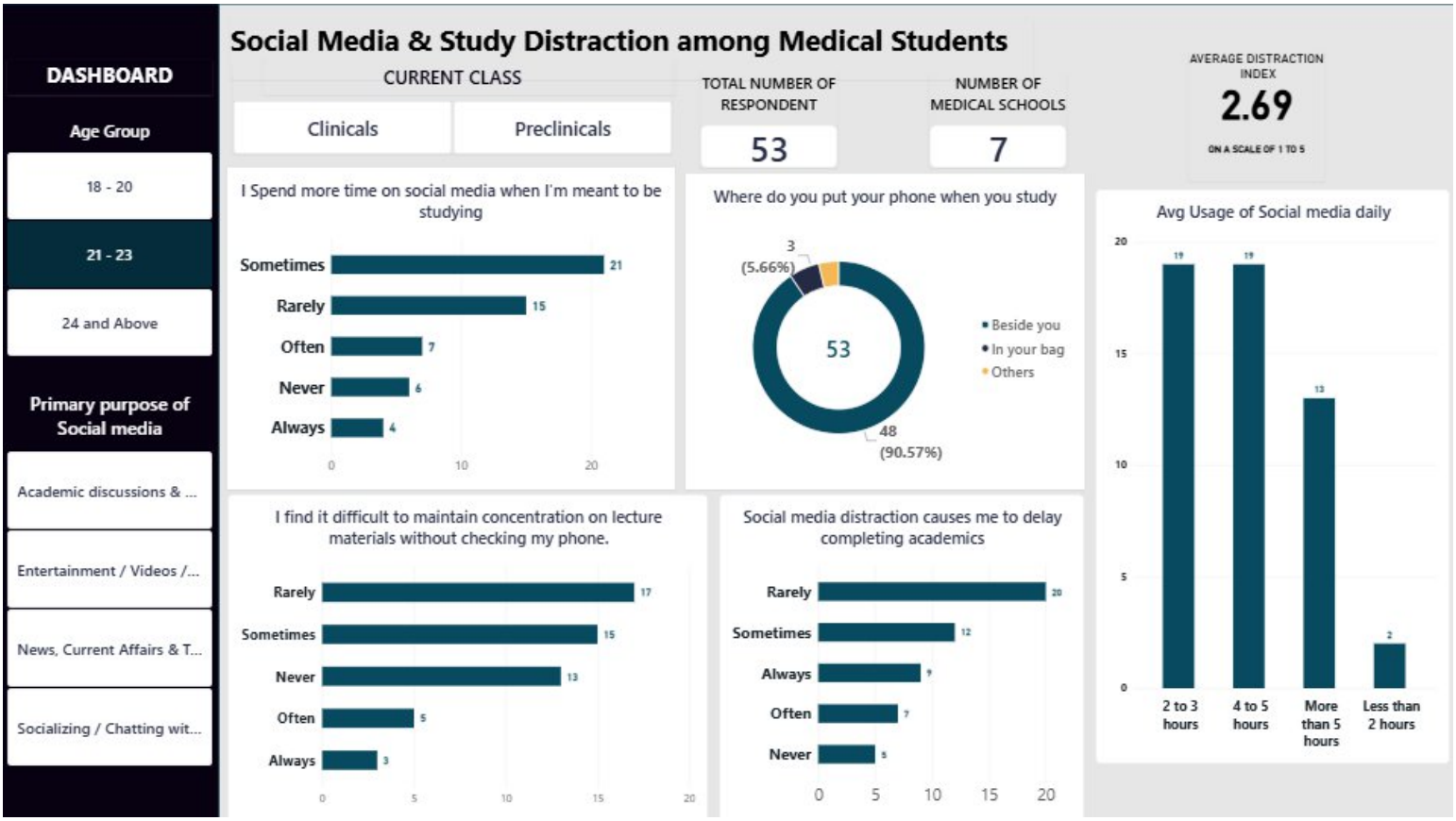


AGE GROUP 18 - 20

The dashboard shows 42 respondents (43% of the sample) from 9 institutions, mainly Bayelsa Medical University (14), the University of Ilorin (12) and Benson Idahosa University (8). The average Distraction Index is **2.86**, above the overall figure of 2.74. This group uses social media more heavily than the full sample. Half (50%) spend more than five hours a day on it, against 38% overall, and 81% spend at least four hours a day, against 70% overall. Entertainment and video content is the main purpose for 74% (64% overall), followed by socialising (14%) and academic discussion (12%). No one in this age group chose news as their main purpose. Most (88%) keep the phone beside them while studying, in line with the overall result.

Distraction is more frequent than average on the concentration and delay statements. Concentrating on lectures without checking the phone is often or always a problem for 38% (25% overall), and delaying assignments or reading notes affects 33% (32% overall). Spending more time scrolling than intended while studying is reported often or always by 29% (24% overall). The group is also split: 36% to 50% say they never or rarely have these problems, depending on the statement, so heavy use is common but the effect is not uniform.

Overall, 18 to 20 year olds are slightly more distracted than the average respondent, driven by heavier use and a stronger focus on entertainment content.



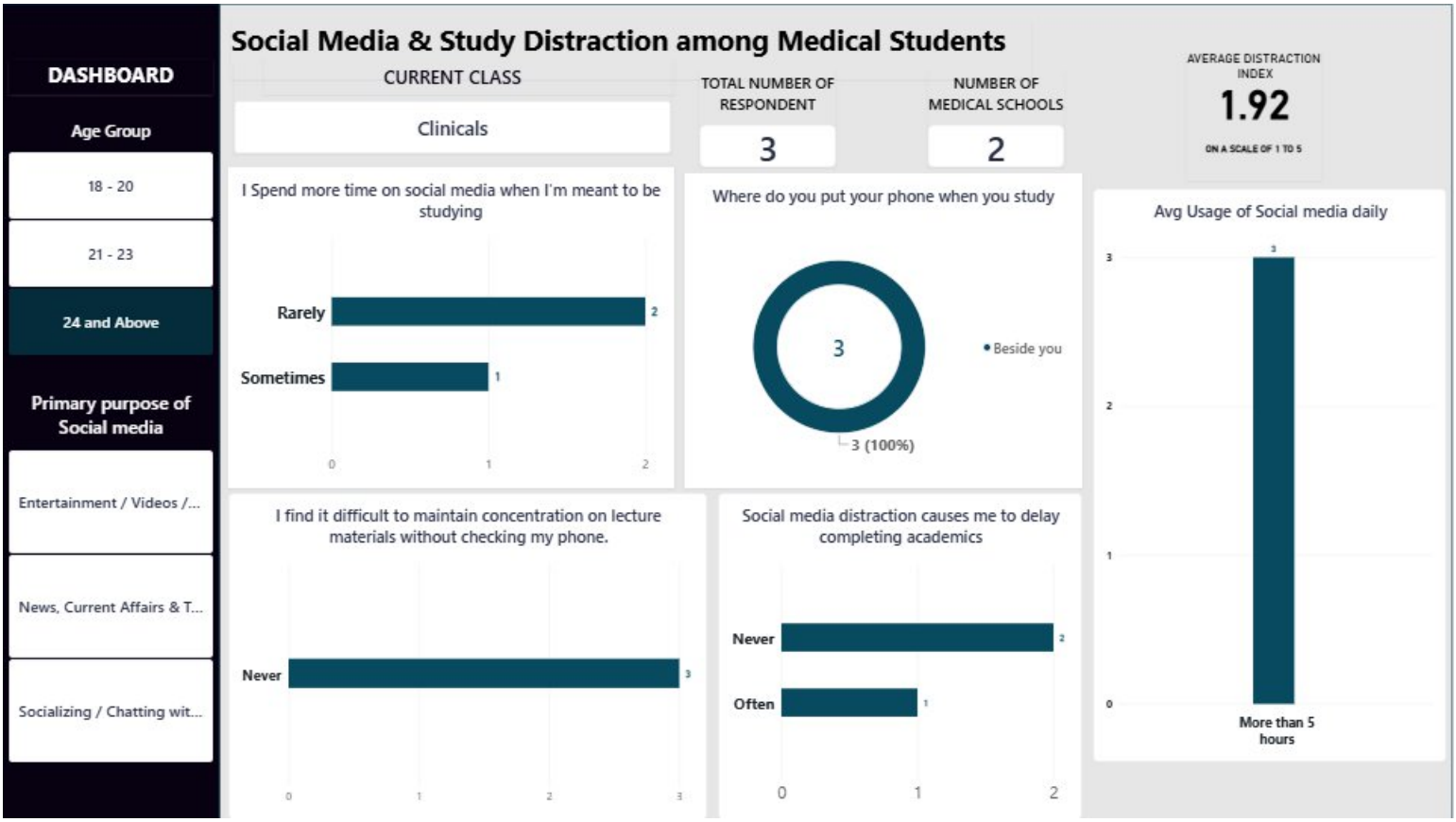
AGE GROUP 21 - 23

The dashboard shows 53 respondents (54% of the sample) from 7 institutions, mainly Bayelsa Medical University (20), the University of Ilorin (18) and Benson Idahosa University (10). This group is mostly clinical students (87%), with 13% preclinical. The average Distraction Index is **2.69**.

Social media use is lighter than in the full sample. A quarter (25%) spend more than five hours a day, against 38% overall, and 60% spend at least four hours, against 70% overall. Entertainment and video content is still the main purpose (58%), but socialising is more common here (23%, against 19% overall), followed by news (11%) and academic discussion (8%). Most (91%) keep the phone beside them while studying, in line with the overall result.

Distraction is milder than average on most statements. Difficulty concentrating on lectures without checking the phone is often or always a problem for just 15% (25% overall), and 57% say they never or rarely struggle. Spending more time scrolling than intended while studying affects 21% (24% overall). Delaying assignments or reading notes remains the biggest issue at 30% (32% overall), and “Sometimes” is the most common answer to the scrolling statement.

Overall, 21 to 23 year olds are slightly less distracted than the average respondent, which fits their lighter usage and larger share of socialising. The differences from the full sample are small, and these are self-reported results from 53 students, so treat the comparison as indicative rather than conclusive. Delayed assignments is the one area where this group looks like everyone else.



AGE GROUP 24 and ABOVE

The dashboard shows only 3 respondents (3% of the sample), so the sample is too small for any reliable conclusion. They come from two institutions (one from Bayelsa Medical University and two from the University of Ilorin), and all three are clinical students. The average Distraction Index is **1.92**, the lowest of any age group, but with three people it should not be treated as a finding.

All three students spend more than five hours a day on social media, and all keep the phone beside them while studying. Their main purposes differ: one uses it for news, one for entertainment and one for socializing. Distraction responses are mostly low. Two of the three say they never or rarely have difficulty concentrating on lectures, and only one reports often or always delaying assignments.

Because a single respondent changes the group's percentages by a third, no conclusions can be drawn.

CURRENT CLASS + PRIMARY PURPOSE

Class	Purpose	n	Avg distraction index
Clinicals	Entertainment	52	2.85
Clinicals	Socializing	14	2.30
Clinicals	News	6 †	2.75
Clinicals	Academic	4 †	3.00
Preclinicals	Entertainment	11	2.93
Preclinicals	Socializing	5 †	2.25
Preclinicals	Academic	5 †	2.90
Preclinicals	News	1 †	1.75

How the Distraction Index Is Calculated

The Distraction Index is a single score that summarizes how much social media interferes with a student's studying. It is based on four statements in the survey:

1. I lose focus during study sessions because I check social media notifications.
2. I spend more time scrolling on social media than intended when I am supposed to be studying.
3. Social media distraction causes me to delay completing academic assignments or reading notes.
4. I find it difficult to maintain concentration on lecture materials without checking my phone.

Respondents answered each statement on a five-point scale, which was converted to numbers: Never = 1, Rarely = 2, Sometimes = 3, Often = 4 and Always = 5. Each respondent's index is the average of their four scores, so it ranges from 1 (never distracted) to 5 (always distracted). For example, a student who answered Often, Sometimes, Often and Rarely scores $(4 + 3 + 4 + 2) \div 4 = 3.25$. The overall index is the average of all respondents' scores, and when a slicer is applied it is the average for the selected group only.